

Recommendations for Acute Training Variables

	Training Goal (Level of OPT™)	Untrained and Inexperienced	Intermediate	Trained and Experienced
1. Repetitions	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	12+	12+	12+
	Strength	8 to 12	5 to 10	Depends on performance goal
	Power	3 to 6	3 to 6	1 to 6
2. Sets	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	1 to 2	1 to 3	1 to 3
	Strength	1 to 2	2 to 5	Depends on performance goal
	Power	1 to 2	2 to 3	3
3. Intensity	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	Low	Moderate	High
	Strength	50 to 70% of the estimated 1RM	60 to 80% of the 1RM	70 to 85% of the 1RM
	Power	30 to 60% of the 1RM (velocity)	30 to 60% of the 1RM (velocity)	
4. Tempo	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	Controlled	Moderate	Moderate
	Strength	Moderate	Moderate	Depends on training goal
	Power	Gradually increase the velocity from moderate to fast (1 second or less) as technique improves.	Fast (1 second or less)	Fast (1 second or less)
5. Volume	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	1 to 2 sets, 10 to 15 reps	2 to 3 sets, 10 to 15 reps	≥3 sets, 10 to 15 reps
	Strength	1 to 2 sets, 10 to 15 reps	2 to 3 sets, 8 to 12 reps	≥3 sets, 6 to 10 reps
	Power	1 to 2 sets, 3 to 6 reps	2 to 3 sets, 3 to 6 reps	≥3 sets, 1 to 6 reps
6. Rest	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	As much as needed	30 seconds or less	30 seconds or less
	Strength	1 minute	1 minute	1 minute
	Power	1 minute	1 to 2	2 to 3
7. Frequency	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	2 to 3 nonconsecutive days	2 to 3 nonconsecutive days	2 to 3 nonconsecutive days

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8. Exercise Selection	Strength	2 to 3 days	2 to 3 days	3 to 4 days
	Power	2 days	2 to 3 days	2 to 3 days
	Stabilization/Muscle Endurance	Variety of bodyweight and resistance (bands, barbells, dumbbells, kettlebells, etc.)	Variety of bodyweight and resistance (bands, barbells, dumbbells, kettlebells, etc.)	Variety of bodyweight and resistance (bands, barbells, dumbbells, kettlebells, etc.)
	Strength	Single-joint, multi-joint, and total-body; concentric and eccentric	Single-joint, multi-joint, and total-body; concentric and eccentric	Single-joint, multi-joint, and total-body; concentric and eccentric
	Power	Multi-joint and total-body; concentric and eccentric	Multi-joint and total-body; concentric and eccentric	Multi-joint and total-body; concentric and eccentric